

I thought that the information you would get in the pit would be the Holy Grail. I just didn't think it through. The reality is that you get almost no useful information.

So being on the floor turned out to be a disadvantage rather than an advantage.

It was a big disadvantage.

How long was it before you realized you made a mistake?

I stayed on the floor for six months. I wanted to give it the old college try.

You felt more comfortable upstairs?

I felt more comfortable being able to see more markets.

By more markets, do you mean charts or just the prices?

At that time, the screens just gave you quotes, not charts. I received a printed chart book each week, and updated the charts every day. I think that was a great process. It made me pay attention to every market, every day. I did that for over 10 years. Even when we got CQG screens, which had graphics, I still continued to update my printed charts manually for a long time. It was a daily routine of looking at each chart and thinking about what the patterns were telling you. I would even turn the charts upside down to see whether the pattern looked different to me. Over time, it helped me develop a sense of pattern recognition.

Were you trading your own account when you were a broker?

I had been trading my own account all along.

How did you do?

I did fine. I made money virtually every year, but I didn't make a lot of money. One thing I did wrong was that I thought only technical factors were important and that fundamentals didn't matter. The other thing I did wrong was that every time I made money, I would pull it out. So instead of increasing my size over time, I stayed a one- and two-lot trader. I never really tried pushing myself. The evolution of a trader is when you start letting your money work for you and increasing your size.